



CAPTAIN AMERICA

STEVE ROGERS was a sickly young man who grew up during the economic depression of the 1930s. When the Nazis invaded Europe,

Steve tried to enlist, but was rejected on health grounds. A general overheard him express his desire to serve his country and offered him a chance to join a program called Operation: Rebirth.

SUPER-SOLDIER

Steve was injected with top-secret Super-Soldier serum and his body was bombarded with "vita-rays." The treatment transformed his weak body into the pinnacle of human perfection. Though he was supposed to be the first of an army of physically enhanced agents, a Nazi spy murdered the serum's inventor and Steve thus became the Army's one and only super-soldier.



SYMBOL OF FREEDOM

After intense training in gymnastics and martial arts, Steve Rogers was given a costume patterned after his country's flag and code-named Captain America.



Bucky Barnes
Orphan James Buchanan "Bucky" Barnes was a mascot at Camp Lehigh, Virginia, where Steve Rogers was stationed. After accidentally learning Steve's secret identity, Bucky trained with Captain America and gained his own costume.



FATAL MOMENT

Cap could only look on helplessly as Bucky tried to defuse the bomb.

Bucky's Death

Toward the end of World War II, Cap and Bucky tried to foil Baron Zemo's scheme to steal a bomb-laden drone plane. As the plane took off, Bucky leaped aboard and was killed defusing the bomb. Captain America fell into the sea, where the Super-Soldier formula caused him to enter a state of suspended animation.



Reborn

The unconscious Captain America drifted in the ocean until he became frozen in a block of ice. Decades later he was found (below) and revived by the newly formed Avengers. Invited to join the team, he formed a close friendship with

Rick Jones, who became his partner for a while. Cap possesses superhuman strength, speed, agility, and endurance. His shield is made of an unknown, virtually indestructible alloy and is a perfectly balanced throwing weapon.



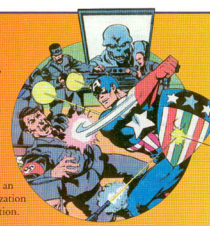
Discovering Captain America

Skilled in every known form of hand-to-hand combat, Captain America is also a master of strategy. He first assumed leadership of the Avengers when the original four members decided to leave and he helped recruit the new team. Though he has occasionally left for brief periods, Cap has always been a cornerstone of the Avengers. He is also a symbol of liberty and justice.



Red Skull

While working as a bellboy, Johann Schmidt met Adolf Hitler who trained him to become a Nazi super-agent. After repeatedly battling Captain America during World War II, the Red Skull was placed in suspended animation and later revived. He now runs an unnamed subversive organization dedicated to world domination.



Costume Change

Captain America's costume is one of the most instantly recognizable of all heroes'. However, he has occasionally changed his look when the situation demanded it.

THE CAPTAIN

Temporarily freed by the U.S. government, Cap wore a black version of his costume for a few months.



IN ARMOR

When his super-soldier serum mutated and left him paralyzed, Cap had to wear an armored exoskeleton designed by Tony Stark.



THE EX-PATRIOT

Accused of being a traitor, Cap adopted another new costume when he was temporarily exiled from his beloved America.



The Invaders

During World War II, Cap helped form the Invaders. Along with Bucky, the original Human Torch, his partner Toro and the Sub-Mariner, Cap battled the superhuman agents of the Axis Powers. Later members included Union Jack, Spitfire, the Whizzer and Miss America.

